

AEGIS DESIGN SYSTEM — V2.0

DESIGN SYSTEM.

// the single source for all visual and interaction decisions — tokens, components, patterns, and accessibility standards as implemented in production.

VERSION

2.0 — 2026-05-21

FRAMEWORK

Next.js + React + Tailwind CSS

STATUS

● Active — Production

WCAG

2.1 AA

BRAND FOUNDATION

PURPOSE

AEGIS exists to distinguish genuine human reasoning from AI-generated responses. Every design decision reinforces this mission: deliberate, technical, authoritative.

PRECISION

Exact spacing grids. No arbitrary values. Token-driven colour. Every number has a reason.

TRANSPARENCY

Clear status indicators. Honest error messages. Users always know where they are and what the system is doing.

ACCESSIBILITY

WCAG 2.1 AA is the floor, not the ceiling. Baked into every token, every component, every pattern — not bolted on after.

CONTENT GUIDELINES

// text formatting rules for specific UI elements

NAVIGATION LABELS

ASSESSMENTS · CANDIDATES · REPORTS

Uppercase, no trailing punctuation, 1-2 words max

BUTTONS (PRIMARY/SECONDARY)

START ASSESSMENT · SAVE DRAFT · DEPLOY

Verb-first, uppercase, 2-4 words, no periods

ERROR MESSAGES

UNABLE TO LOAD ASSESSMENTS.

Sentence case, states problem clearly, no "Sorry" or "Please"

STATUS INDICATORS

ACTIVE

PENDING

CLOSED

DRAFT

Single word, all-caps, paired with semantic colour

EMPTY STATES

NO ASSESSMENTS ASSIGNED YET.

Sentence case, explains absence, no technical jargon

CONFIRMATION MESSAGES

ASSESSMENT DEPLOYED SUCCESSFULLY.

Sentence case, past tense, includes action + outcome

// 01 — DESIGN TOKENS

TOKENS

Design tokens are named variables that store visual attributes. Each token maps directly to a CSS custom property and a Figma style.

COLOUR TOKENS

background

#0F0F0E

Global page background

secondary-surface

#121211

Cards, navbars, panels

card / elevated

#1A1C1E

Elevated card surfaces

tertiary-surface

#30302E

Borders, dividers, hover

system-red

#B42715

CTA, active states, focus ring

white-smoke / default-text

#F5F5F5

Primary text & headings

default-border / muted

#989892

Borders, placeholder text

// semantic / status colours

status-success — #66BB6A

status-warning — #FFCA28

error-red — #C64545

info-blue — #64B5F6

TOKEN REFERENCE

TOKEN NAME	HEX VALUE	USE CASE
background	#0F0F0E	Global page background
secondary-surface	#121211	Cards, navbars, panels
tertiary-surface	#30302E	Borders, dividers, hover backgrounds
system-red	#B42715	CTA buttons, active states, focus rings
white-smoke / default-text	#F5F5F5	Primary text, headings, labels
default-border	#989892	Input borders, card edges
status-success	#66BB6A	Success states, active badges
status-warning	#FFCA28	Pending, caution states
error-red	#C64545	Validation errors, negative feedback
info-blue	#64B5F6	Draft state, informational badges

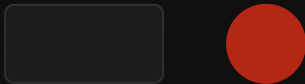
RULE: Use role-based token names in all component code — never raw hex values. Use `bg-system-red` not `bg-[#B42715]`. The 60/30/10 rule applies: background dominates surfaces, secondary-surface structures content, system-red does the work.

SPACING TOKENS — 8PX GRID

- 4pxxs — p-1 — icon gaps, fine adjustments
- 8pxsm — p-2 — button padding, tight gaps
- 16pxmd — p-4 — standard component padding, card gaps
- 24pxlg — p-6 — section spacing, panel padding
- 32pxxl — p-8 — major section breaks
- 48px2xl — p-12 — hero spacing, page-level gaps

All spacing is a multiple of 8px. Never use arbitrary values like 17px or 23px.

BORDER RADIUS



// 02 — TYPOGRAPHY

TYPOGRAPHY

Typography is restricted to three font families. Each serves a distinct functional role.

FONT STACK

STAATLICHES

font-staatliches
Headings, buttons,
UI chrome

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ASSESSMENT ARSENAL

CONTINUE → DEPLOY ASSESSMENT SAVE DRAFT

IBM PLEX SANS

font-ibm
Body copy, descriptions,
form content

Start an assessment with carefully curated adversarial questions designed to evaluate genuine human reasoning.

Secondary body copy at 13px — descriptions, help text, card content.

JETBRAINS MONO

font-jetbrains
Labels, metadata,
timestamps, code

ASSESSMENT TITLE *

// configure an adversarial assessment set

2026-05-21 · v2.0 · SYSTEM ONLINE

TYPE SCALE

ELEMENT	FONT	SIZE	TAILWIND CLASS
Page Hero H1	Staatliches	56px	text-5xl font-staatliches
Page Title H2	Staatliches	36px	text-3xl font-staatliches tracking-[.06em]
Panel Title	Staatliches	22px	text-[22px] font-staatliches tracking-[.07em]
Section Header	Staatliches	16px	text-base font-staatliches tracking-[.07em]

Body	IBM Plex Sans	16px	text-base font-ibm leading-relaxed
Body Small	IBM Plex Sans	13px	text-[13px] font-ibm
UI Label	JetBrains Mono	10px	font-jetbrains text-[10px] tracking-[.1em]
Caption / Meta	JetBrains Mono	9–10px	font-jetbrains text-[10px] text-white-smoke/40
Button Text	Staatliches	13–15px	font-staatliches text-sm tracking-[.05em]

// 03 — COMPONENT LIBRARY

COMPONENTS

Each component defines its props, available states (default, hover, focus, disabled), accessibility attributes, and usage constraints. Components are built independently and composed into layouts

BUTTONS

LIVE PREVIEW

ADMIN PANEL — White primary (hovers to red outline)

CONTINUE →

DEPLOY ASSESSMENT

SAVE DRAFT

← BACK

×

primary admin

hover state

ghost

ghost nav

icon close

CANDIDATE PORTAL — Red primary

START ASSESSMENT

SECONDARY ACTION

DISABLED

primary candidate

outline red

disabled

VARIANT	CONTEXT	DEFAULT STYLE	HOVER STYLE
Primary Admin	Admin panels, wizards	bg-default-text text-background	bg-transparent border-system-red text-system-red
Primary Candidate	Candidate portal CTAs	bg-system-red text-white	bg-[#D64530]
Ghost	Secondary actions	border-default-border text-white-smoke/40	border-white-smoke/40 text-white-smoke

Icon button	Close, actions	border-default-border text-white-smoke/40	border-system-red text-system-red
Disabled	Any unavailable action	opacity-50 cursor-not-allowed	No interaction

STATUS BADGES

LIVE PREVIEW

ACTIVE

PENDING

CLOSED

DRAFT

STATUS	BACKGROUND	TEXT	BORDER
ACTIVE	rgba(56,142,60,0.18)	#66BB6A	rgba(56,142,60,0.3)
PENDING	rgba(255,202,40,0.12)	#FFCA28	rgba(255,202,40,0.3)
CLOSED	rgba(51,51,49,0.6)	#989892	#30302E
DRAFT	rgba(100,181,246,0.12)	#64B5F6	rgba(100,181,246,0.3)

ASSESSMENT CARD (CANDIDATE)

// hover to see interaction state

LIVE PREVIEW – HOVER THE CARDS

JS ALGORITHM SPRINT

A series of adversarial algorithm challenges design...

📄

Duration: 60 mins

👤

Status: READY TO START

START ASSESSMENT

SQL INJECTION TRAPS

Adversarial SQL challenges with embedded query traps ...

📄

Duration: 45 mins

👤

Status: READY TO START

START ASSESSMENT

ASSESSMENT CARD (ADMIN)

// coloured top border indicates status at a glance

JS ALGORITHM SPRINT

ACTIVE

Backend

Mid

?

16 Qs

JavaScript, TypeScript

Algorithm

Debugging

Code

34

CANDIDATES

82%

COMPLETED

72%

AI DETECT

FULL-STACK GAUNTLET

PENDING

Full-Stack

Lead

?

24 Qs

JavaScript, Python

Code

Debugging

Algorithm

System Design

41

CANDIDATES

0%

COMPLETED

—

AI DETECT

BACKEND DEBUG CHALLENGE

CLOSED

Backend

Senior

?

12 Qs

Python, Java

Debugging

Code

System Design

22

CANDIDATES

100%

COMPLETED

38%

AI DETECT

FRONTEND REACT TRAPS

DRAFT

Frontend

Junior

?

10 Qs

JavaScript, TypeScript

Code

Debugging

0

CANDIDATES

0%

COMPLETED

—

AI DETECT

FORM INPUTS

ASSESSMENT TITLE *

e.g. Senior Backend Algorithm Sprint

DEFAULT STATE — border-default-border (#989892)

DESCRIPTION — FOCUS STATE

// configure an adversarial assessment set

FOCUS STATE — border-system-red (#B42715)

EMAIL — ERROR STATE

not-an-email

⚠ Invalid email format

ERROR STATE — border-error-red (#C64545) + message

FIELD — DISABLED STATE

Cannot be modified

DISABLED — bg-tertiary-surface, cursor-not-allowed

NAVIGATION BAR (CANDIDATE)



ADMIN SIDEBAR



ADMIN CMD

OPERATIONS

- DASHBOARD
 - **ASSESSMENTS**
 - CANDIDATES
 - QUESTION BANK
- SYSTEM
- SETTINGS

SECTION TITLE PATTERN

LIVE PREVIEW

ASSESSMENT IDENTITY

TIME CONFIGURATION

BEHAVIOUR & SECURITY

ICONOGRAPHY

// /public/illustrations/icons/ – all SVG, inverted on dark backgrounds via brightness-0 invert



file-icon.svg

24px – card meta



users-icon.svg

24px – card meta



pie-chart-icon.svg

24px – analytics



clock-icon.svg

24px – timer



search-icon.svg

20px – nav



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// 04 — DESIGN PATTERNS

PATTERNS

Patterns are reusable solutions to recurring layout and interaction problems. They compose atoms into organisms.

ATOMIC DESIGN HIERARCHY

COMPONENT HIERARCHY

01

ATOMS

Button

Input

Toggle

Badge

Icon

02

MOLECULES

Form row

Search bar

Status pill

Meta pill

03

ORGANISMS

Assessment
Card

Filter Bar

Navbar

04

TEMPLATES

Admin Layout

Candidate
Layout

Create Panel

05

PAGES

Assessment
Arsenal

Candidate Home

Assessment
Session

PAGE LAYOUT PATTERNS

CANDIDATE LAYOUT

Full-width navbar, generous padding, 4-column card grid on desktop.

```
[Navbar — full width]
[main px-6 md:px-12 py-8]
  [H1 Staatliches 3xl]
  [Subtext IBM Plex]
  [grid-cols-4 gap-x-32]
    [Card] [Card] [Card] [Card]
[Footer — full width]
```

ADMIN LAYOUT

220px fixed sidebar, topbar, scrollable main content area.

```
[Sidebar 220px] | [Main flex-1]
                  | [Topbar 60px]
                  | [Content px-7 py-6]
                  | [Page header]
                  | [Filter bar]
                  | [Grid content]
```

PANEL SLIDE-OVER

Right-anchored 720px panel over a 60% black overlay. Keeps context visible.

```
[Overlay bg-black/60 z-50]
[Panel w-[720px] right-0]
  [Header + close btn]
  [Stepper]
  [Body - scrollable]
  [Footer - nav btns]
```

LOADING / ERROR / EMPTY

Consistent three-state pattern for async data in candidate pages.

```
Loading:
  "Loading assessments..."
  text-white-smoke, pt-8

Error:
  "{error message}"
  text-system-red, pt-8

Empty:
  "No assessments assigned yet."
  text-white-smoke, pt-8
```

// 05 - ACCESSIBILITY - WCAG 2.1 AA

ACCESSIBILITY

Accessibility requirements are enforced at the component level. All UI elements must meet WCAG 2.1 AA standards for contrast, keyboard navigation, and screen reader compatibility.

CONTRAST RATIOS

#F5F5F5 text 16.5:1 ratio AAA ✓ - Primary text on bg	#F5F5F5 text 15.8:1 ratio AAA ✓ - Card titles	White text 5.3:1 ratio AA ✓ - Red buttons
Red text 5.1:1 ratio AA ✓ - Red on bg	Success text 6.8:1 ratio AAA ✓ - Status success	Muted text 3.8:1 ratio WARN - UI only, not body text

PRE-DEPLOYMENT CHECKLIST

CATEGORY	REQUIREMENT	HOW TO VERIFY
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Contrast	All body text $\geq 4.5:1$, UI components $\geq 3:1$	WAVE / Axe DevTools
Keyboard	All interactive elements reachable via Tab; logical order	Tab through page with mouse off
Focus	Visible 2px outline on all focusable elements, colour system-red	:focus-visible in DevTools
Modal/Panel	Focus trapped within; Escape closes; returns focus to trigger	Tab inside panel; press Escape
ARIA	Toggle switches have role="switch" + aria-checked; icon buttons have aria-label	Inspect element attributes
Semantic HTML	main, nav, header, footer, section; one H1 per page	HTML outline view
Forms	All inputs have label with htmlFor; errors use aria-describedby	Screen reader test
Images	Descriptive alt text on all meaningful images; brightness-0 invert for icon SVGs	Inspect alt attributes
Colour alone	State never conveyed by colour alone; always pair with text or icon	Greyscale screenshot test
Touch	Touch targets $\geq 44 \times 44$ px on mobile	Chrome DevTools mobile emulation

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Design System v2.0 — COS301 Capstone 2026 — Maintained by the AEGIS Development Team

[Figma](#) →

[GitHub](#) →

[Tailwind](#) →

[WCAG 2.1](#) →